

With simplicity and stability continuing to be top priorities,

Slackware 12.2

doesn't disappoint.

I have tried out many flavours of GNU/Linux over the years—starting from Red Hat 9 to Fedora 10, Ubuntu, Sabayon, openSUSE, etc. In my book, all of these have their pros and cons, although I keep distro hopping not because of their cons, but because I am fickle and get bored with using the same thing for a period of time.

When I heard that *LFY* was bundling the latest Slackware 12.2, it reminded me that this was one distro I was yet to try out; besides, I wasn't all that happy with Sabayon 4 that I was currently using on my home computer. Slackware, as you know, is the oldest surviving GNU/Linux, whose roots go way back to the early 90s, and a motto to keep things stable and simple. Version 12.2 was released on December 11, 2008, and I wanted to see if they still lived by that motto.

Now, when Slackware says that it's focus is on simplicity, don't take that to mean the typical 'click-next' stuff we generally associate the term with. In fact, technically speaking, 'click-next' makes things more and more complicated due to various top-tier UI abstractions that try to obscure the backend command-line. So, when they say Slackware likes to stick to simplicity, it means things are kept

in line with the upstream, without any distro-specific customisation. In a way, it tries to stay aligned to the original UNIX philosophy—why break things if it still works well.

This brings me to the installation procedure. You'll still find the same installer that's perhaps been in use for the last few years—maybe even for a decade or more. The installation and package configuration for Slackware is all text-based.

Before I talk about the installation, a new experience for me, here are the specs for my test system

- Pentium 4 with HT technology
- Intel 865 motherboard
- 1 GB RAM
- 80 GB hard drive

Ready for installation

After popping in the DVD, I was greeted with a non-graphical interface. A word of advice for people who have never tried anything that's not graphical: you need to pay attention to the things being displayed on the screen... keep reading!

Now, with the bootable DVD inside and everything on-screen in black and white, I started reading every page on-screen to make the proper choices. First, you will be asked to select a keyboard layout. Once

